



A: Mega infrastructure investments in power, logistics and connectivity convert our industrial ambitions into industrial output. Samruddhi Mahamarg, a 700-km expressway built at a cost of \$6.9 billion, carrying 11 million daily riders, opened to traffic in June 2025, enhancing connectivity across 24 districts. The Shakti Peeth Expressway, an 856-km corridor linking Nagpur to Goa at a cost of \$10 billion, will extend this same connectivity-led growth model into new regions.

Navi Mumbai International Airport, built at a cost of \$2.6 billion with a planned capacity of 90 million passengers a year, began operations in October 2025, giving the Mumbai Metropolitan Region a second international gateway. Metro projects across Pune, Mumbai and Nagpur, backed by \$21.8 billion in investment and carrying nine million daily riders, are reducing commute times. The Mumbai-Pune bullet train is also in the pipeline, expected to cut travel time between the two cities to 48 minutes.

Maharashtra has a total installed generation capacity of 60.6 GW, with around 50 power sourced from renewable energy, providing long-term energy security for industries and infrastructure projects. It has achieved 31.3 GW of renewable energy capacity as of January 2026, with 24.3 GW added since 2015, supported by proactive state policies.

Renewable capacity has more than doubled over the past decade. The recently approved Mukhyamantri Saur Krushi Vahini Yojana 2.0 aims to shift 100% agricultural electricity demand to daytime supply by September 2026 and add around 16 GW of solar capacity by March 2027.

Q: Once a naxal stronghold, Gadchiroli has today emerged as a major mining belt that is seeing huge investments from companies like JSW and Lloyds Metals. How key is this region going to be for the state's and country's economic growth?

A: The investment momentum in Gadchiroli opens a largely untapped resource base—60% of Maharashtra's total area with potential mineral reserves lies within the Nagpur division, of which Gadchiroli is a part. MIDC has proposed new industrial estates in Gadchiroli district's Armori and Chamorshi, with land acquisition already underway; it is intended to draw MSMEs and value-added investment in forest and mineral processing.

Lloyds Metals & Energy is investing ₹45,000 crore,

building a 4.5 MTPA integrated steel plant and a 4 MTPA pellet plant, expected to create 30,000 jobs. JSW Group is investing ₹1,00,000 crore to build what will be the world's largest steel plant, at 25 MTPA capacity, with land acquisition already underway.

Over 40 projects in Gadchiroli and Chandrapur are expected to bring investments of nearly ₹6,70,000 crore and create more than two lakh jobs, transforming the region into a major industrial and employment hub. These are not standalone factories. Each comes with environmentally conscious design and social infrastructure that makes a mining belt liveable: townships, hospitals, and CBSE schools are being built alongside the plants.

We are backing this with connectivity that didn't exist before. An airport for Gadchiroli is in the

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pipeline, and the Nagpur-Chandrapur expressway will connect directly to the Samruddhi Mahamarg. Gadchiroli already sits close to Nagpur International Airport and the Nagpur ICD, both roughly 170 km away, and we are extending logistics links, including slurry pipeline connectivity.

Gadchiroli is positioned to become India's steel city. Alongside this industrial growth, we remain committed to protecting Gadchiroli's land, water and forest with afforestation and sustainability built into the plan.

Q: Last year, Maharashtra became the first state to approve a policy for shipbuilding, repair and recycling. Could you tell us more on the vision and the timelines?

A: Our aim is that Maharashtra must contribute at least one-third of India's entire shipbuilding, repair and recycling output. We are targeting 0.17 million GT by